



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-26
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I [SETA]

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*Attempt all five questions.
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].
This paper consists of five printed pages.*

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- (i) Write an original short story that begins with the words: “There was something unusual about the stranger who walked into the cafe...”
- (ii) Describe an unexpected incident that occurred during a trip with your family. What did you see, hear and feel at that time? How did the people around you react and what did you learn from the experience?
- (iii) Narrate an experience from your life when you had to make a difficult decision. What circumstances led to it? How did you feel during the process and what valuable lesson did you take away from that experience?
- (iv) *Watching movies helps one learn essential life lessons. Give your views either for or against the statement.*
- (v) Study the picture given below. Write a story, a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- (i) Your friend has been spending a lot of time on online gaming and is neglecting his/her studies. Write a letter to your friend expressing your concern. Mention the harmful effects of such addiction and suggest some enjoyable ways for relaxation and entertainment.
- (ii) Write a letter to the Director of West Bengal Transport Corporation requesting improvements in the safety and cleanliness of public buses. Mention the difficulties faced by students and daily passengers. Suggest simple ways to make the bus journey better.

Question 3

- (i) Your school is hosting an Inter-School Science Innovation Competition. Draft a notice for your school notice board inviting the students of Classes IX and X to take part in this event. [5]

- (ii) As the President of the Science Club, write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school requesting him/her to send four participants for the event. Give details of the event. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

[20]

It was a warm afternoon in the small town of Malgudi. The streets were quiet and the shops were closing for the midday break. The scent of jasmine and dry earth hung in the air. Swami, a young boy with a curious mind and a head full of questions, was returning home from school, swinging his bag absentmindedly and humming a tune.

As he walked past the banyan tree near the village temple — the tree that children often avoided because of the old stories about spirits that lived in it — he noticed a long, dark object lying motionless on the ground. At first, he thought it was a stick but something about it made him stop.

Swami stepped closer and looked suspiciously. It was a snake, coiled tightly and blending perfectly with the dry grass beneath it. Its body *shimmered* slightly under the sun. For a moment, Swami felt a surge of fear rise in his chest — the kind of fear that makes you want to run without looking back. But then his natural curiosity took over. He had heard many stories about snakes from his grandfather — some frightening, some fascinating — but he had never seen one so closely.

The snake appeared calm. Swami crouched down cautiously, keeping a safe distance. He reached out a hand, hesitantly, just to feel the air between them. Suddenly, the snake flicked its tongue and shifted slightly in the grass. Swami stumbled back, his heart pounding but he did not scream. Instead, he stood frozen, eyes wide with wonder.

At that moment, a deep voice called out from behind him. It was the village elder, a man with a walking stick and silver hair, known for his wisdom and knowledge of animals and nature. “Don’t worry,” he said gently. “That snake is harmless. It is a rat snake — not *venomous*. In fact, it helps the village by keeping the rats away.”

Swami exhaled in relief, though his legs still trembled. The elder came forward and stood beside him, both now watching the snake as it slowly uncoiled and slithered towards a nearby bush. Its movement was elegant.

Swami spent the rest of the afternoon listening to the village elder talk about snakes, birds and the forest that once bordered the village. The stories were filled with awe and respect, not fear. When Swami finally walked home, the sun was lower in the sky and the air had cooled.

That evening, he told his family about the snake and all that he had learnt. He realized that fear often comes from not knowing — from imagining the worst. From that day on, Swami looked at the world around him with new eyes — not just with curiosity but also with understanding and kindness.

(i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage): [2]

1. *shimmered*

(a) sparkled

(c) made noise

(b) turned sharply

(d) flew past

2. *venomous*

(a) safe

(c) poisonous

(b) immortal

(d) friendly

(ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word ‘carelessly’? [1]

(a) suspiciously

(c) hesitantly

(b) cautiously

(d) slithered

(iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

(a) Describe the setting of the town of Malgudi on that warm afternoon. [2]

(b) What was Swami’s initial reaction on seeing the snake? Why was he curious soon after? [2]

(c) Describe Swami’s reaction when the snake moved. What does this tell you about his character? [2]

(d) What did Swami realize about fear? How did Swami’s outlook on the world change after the incident? [2]

(e) Quote a sentence from the passage which tells us that Swami used to share his experiences with his family members. [1]

(iv) In not more than 50 words, describe the village elder and his interaction with Swami. [8]

Question 5

(i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in the correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example (0) began [4]

We (0) _____ (begin) our expedition before sunrise, hoping to reach the glacier by midday. The sky (1) _____ (seem) clear at first but dark clouds soon gathered over the distant peaks. Dr. Lin, our team leader, (2) _____ (warn) us that the weather could change quickly in this region.

As we climbed higher, the temperature dropped and the wind (3) _____ (grow) stronger. We (4) _____ (not cover) even half the distance when snow started to fall. Visibility dropped and the narrow trail became difficult to follow. Our guide, who (5) _____ (trek) through this terrain many times, stopped and examined the landscape carefully. Suddenly, a low rumble echoed through the valley. “Avalanche!” someone shouted. We (6) _____ (rush) to a nearby ridge for shelter as a wall of snow roared past where we had stood moments ago. Thankfully, everyone (7) _____ (make) it to safety. We waited in silence. Later, we (8) _____ (decide) to set up camp and wait for the weather to clear before continuing.

(ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words:

[4]

- (a) The players protested _____ the decision of the referee.
- (b) We must abide _____ the rules if we want to stay in the competition.
- (c) The kitten was hiding _____ the table during the thunderstorm.
- (d) She was deeply interested _____ ancient history and archaeology.
- (e) I promised to look _____ my neighbour's dog during the summer vacation.
- (f) She was prevented _____ attending the meeting due to sudden illness.
- (g) The athlete was proud _____ representing her country at the international level.
- (h) The book is divided _____ several chapters, each focussing on a different theme.

(iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*.
Choose the correct option. [4]

1. She was determined to succeed. She worked day and night.
 - (a) As she was determined to succeed, she worked day and night.
 - (b) She was determined to succeed so she worked day and night.
 - (c) Because she had worked day and night, she was determined to succeed.
 - (d) She worked day and night unless she was determined to succeed.
2. Ravi is not guilty. Ramesh is not guilty.
 - (a) Either Ravi or Ramesh is not guilty.
 - (b) Not only Ravi but also Ramesh is guilty.
 - (c) Neither Ravi nor Ramesh is guilty.
 - (d) Neither Ravi nor Ramesh are guilty.
3. The guests arrived. We served them refreshments immediately.
 - (a) Hardly did the guests arrive, we served them refreshments.
 - (b) No sooner did the guests arrived than we served them refreshments.
 - (c) Hardly did the guests arrive than we served them refreshments.
 - (d) No sooner did the guests arrive than we served them refreshments.
4. She was not familiar with the area. She found out the house easily.
 - (a) She was not familiar with the area unless she found out the house easily.
 - (b) She found out the house easily because she was not familiar with the area.
 - (c) Although she was not familiar with the area, she found out the house easily.
 - (d) She was not familiar with the area but she found out the house easily.

(iv) Choose the correct option to rewrite the following according to the instructions given after each sentence. [8]

1. Scarcely did she step out of the house when it began to rain. (*Begin: As soon as...*)
 - (a) As soon as it began to rain, she had stepped out of the house.
 - (b) As soon as she had stepped out of the house, it began to rain.
 - (c) As soon as she stepped out of the house, it began to rain.
 - (d) As soon as she stepped out of the house, it had begun to rain.
2. He is too unfit to participate in the race. (*Use: so...that*)
 - (a) He is so unfit that he could not participate in the race.
 - (b) He is so unfit that he is not allowed to participate in the race.
 - (c) He is so unfit that he can participate in the race.
 - (d) He is so unfit that he cannot participate in the race.

3. We won the final match. (*Add a question tag*)
- (a) We won the final match, isn't it?
 - (b) We won the final match, didn't we?
 - (c) We won the final match, did we?
 - (d) Did we win the final match?
4. She was so exhausted that she could not keep her eyes open. (*Use: too...to*)
- (a) She was too exhausted to keep her eyes open.
 - (b) She was too exhausted to barely keep her eyes open.
 - (c) She was too exhausted so she did not keep her eyes open.
 - (d) She was too exhausted to keep her eyes closed.
5. He said, "I can finish the work tomorrow." (*Begin: He said that...*)
- (a) He said that I can finish the work tomorrow.
 - (b) He said that he could finish the work the next day.
 - (c) He said that he could finish the work tomorrow.
 - (d) He said that he can finish the work the following day.
6. In spite of working hard, she did not qualify for the finals. (*Use: Despite*)
- (a) Despite working hard, she was not selected for the finals.
 - (b) Despite of hard work, she had qualified for the finals.
 - (c) Despite of working hard, she did not qualify for the finals.
 - (d) Despite working hard, she did not qualify for the finals.
7. The boy has submitted the assignments. (*Begin: The assignments...*)
- (a) The assignments have been submitted by the boy.
 - (b) The assignments has been submitted by the boy.
 - (c) The assignments had been submitted by the boy.
 - (d) The assignments were submitted by the boy.
8. The proposal was rejected because it lacked sufficient evidence. (*Begin: Owing...*)
- (a) Owing of the lack of sufficient evidence, the proposal was rejected.
 - (b) Owing to lack in sufficient evidence, the proposal had rejected.
 - (c) Owing to lack of sufficient evidence, the proposal was rejected.
 - (d) Owing for lacking sufficient evidence, the proposal was rejected.